

Platform adaptation — one design language across eight platforms

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Master technical specification — Volume 10 (Design System), nano-detail deep-dive. This document **owns** how HelixVPN's **one** `helix_design` design system adapts to each of the **eight** supported platforms — **iOS, macOS, Android, Windows, Linux, Web, HarmonyOS, Aurora** — from a **single Flutter codebase** (`helix-ui`) plus the per-platform native tunnel shims. For every platform it pins: the **design-language posture** (Material 3 on the Flutter app, with the native-shim surface following each OS's own HIG / Material / HarmonyDesign / Silica); **which token-export form binds** there (`[token-export-pipeline.md]`); the **navigation idiom**; **system theme (light / dark / auto) integration**; **safe-areas / notches / insets / density / input model** (touch / mouse / remote); **per-platform component substitution**; **capability gating** (the Console-web build has no tunnel core); and the **per-platform accessibility API** the Flutter Semantics tree maps onto (VoiceOver / TalkBack / Narrator / Orca / ...).

SPEC-ONLY. It describes *how the design system meets each platform* — not the shipping `helix_design` / `helix-ui` build. The **token model** (tiers, schema, theming axes) is owned by `[design-tokens.md]`; the **per-target emit forms** (CSS / Dart / SwiftUI / Compose / ArkTS / C-Qt) by `[token-export-pipeline.md]`; the **component catalog** (anatomy, states, a11y baseline, the no-overlap guarantee) by `[component-library.md]`; the **type / icon / motion** families + the per-platform font strategy by `[typography-iconography-motion.md]`;

the **colours + contrast** by [color-system.md]; the **Flutter app shell / capability gating / flavor model** by [v04-client/helix-ui-flutter.md]; the **per-platform tunnel shim bodies** by the shim docs ([v04-client/shim-apple.md], [shim-android.md], [shim-windows.md], [shim-linux.md], [shim-harmonyos.md], [shim-aurora.md]); the **Web Console** by [v04-client/web-console.md]. This document is **original HelixVPN design work**, layered on each framework's documented conventions.

Boundary with sibling docs. Owns: the platform-adaptation posture, the platform × adaptation matrix, the per-OS system-theme / navigation / safe-area / input / a11y mapping, the token→theme→platform binding, the brand-consistency-vs-native-feel decision. Consumes: the seven export forms + the light/dark theme-split [token-export-pipeline.md §3-§4]; the width-not-Platform.isX AdaptiveScaffold rule + the flavor/capability model [helix-ui-flutter.md §2.1, §5]; the system-font-on-native-shims decision (D-TYPE-1) [typography-iconography-motion.md §2.2]; the no-overlap / no-label-overlay guarantee + the a11y baseline [component-library.md §1.3, §1.5]; the per-platform shim surface (SwiftUI / Compose / ArkTS / Qt / named pipe) [the shim docs]; the no-system-tunnel-in-a-browser structural fact [web-console.md §1].

Evidence base. [TEP §N] = final/v10-design/token-export-pipeline.md; [CL §N] = final/v10-design/component-library.md; [DT §N] = final/v10-design/design-tokens.md; [TIM §N] = final/v10-design/typography-iconography-motion.md; [COLOR §N] = final/v10-design/color-system.md; [UIF §N] = final/v04-client/helix-ui-flutter.md; [APPLE §N] = final/v04-client/shim-apple.md; [ANDROID §N] = final/v04-client/shim-android.md; [WIN §N] = final/v04-client/shim-windows.md; [LINUX §N] = final/v04-client/shim-linux.md; [OHOS §N] = final/v04-client/shim-harmonyos.md; [AURORA §N] = final/v04-client/shim-aurora.md; [WEB §N] = final/v04-client/web-console.md; [SPINE §N] = final/SPECIFICATION.md. Claims not grounded in the evidence base or in this document's own original design choices are tagged UNVERIFIED per constitution §11.4.6 — never fabricated. HarmonyOS (HarmonyDesign / ArkUI theming) and Aurora (Sailfish Silica-Qt) platform specifics are tagged UNVERIFIED where they depend on an SDK-version-specific fact this document cannot assert; they are pinned + re-verified per §11.4.99 before the corresponding surface ships.

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0. Position & the core adaptation principle

HelixVPN ships **three apps** (Client / "Access", Console, Connector) across **eight platforms** from **one Flutter UI core** (helix-ui) plus a thin native **tunnel shim** per OS [SPINE §3, UIF §0]. The design system is **one** decoupled submodule (vasic-digital/helix_design, §11.4.28/.29/.74) that configures **OpenDesign** (the mandatory token/theme engine, §11.4.162) and emits its tokens into **seven** consumable forms [TEP §0].

The central adaptation principle — and the load-bearing design decision of this document — is:

D-PA-1 (decided). One brand design language, adapted at the seams; not a wholesale per-OS reskin. HelixVPN renders **its own** brand design language (a Material-3-foundation system via Flutter, OpenDesign-token-driven) **consistently** on the Flutter app across all eight platforms. It does **NOT** swap to a fully native control set (Cupertino-everywhere on iOS, WinUI-everywhere on Windows). The reason is stated verbatim in [TIM §2.1]: a system-font / native-control strategy would make "the *connected* label ... a different shape per OS, a brand-consistency leak" — and the connection-state palette + glyph **must mean the same thing** on every platform ([COLOR §3], [CL §2]) so the user's "am I protected?" answer is identical everywhere. Adaptation therefore happens at the **seams** — navigation idiom, system-theme wiring, safe-areas/insets, input model,

the per-platform **token-export form** that binds the palette, and the **native-shim surface** (which *does* follow each OS's own HIG / Material / HarmonyDesign / Silica because it is genuinely native code) — **not** by reskinning the shared component catalog. Option B (full per-OS native control set) is rejected for the brand-consistency reason above; the honest tradeoff is recorded in §18.

This is consistent with [UIF §2.1]'s AdaptiveScaffold rule: the shell branches on **width**, *never* on Platform.isX — "a resized desktop window behaves like a phone; web just works." Platform identity drives *system integration*, not *which widgets exist*.

ONE design language (shared, all 8 platforms)

helix_design tokens (one
JSON source) [DT]

component catalog:
ConnectButton ·
StatusChip · ExitPicker · ...
[CL]

bundled Inter / JetBrains
Mono in the Flutter app
[TIM §2.1]



ADAPTS at the seams (per platform)

navigation idiom (bottom-
nav / rail / multi-pane) —
by WIDTH [UIF §2.1]

system light/dark/auto
wiring (per-OS mechanism,
S11)

Two kinds of surface per platform. Every platform has (a) the **Flutter app surface** (where the user spends ~all their time — full brand design language, bundled font, the shared catalog), and (b) optionally a **native-shim surface** (a tiny OS-native config/status UI living in the tunnel extension/service — system font per D-TYPE-1 [TIM §2.2], native controls). The two carry the **same palette** (the colour token export reaches both [TEP §4]) but the native-shim surface follows the OS's own design language because it is genuinely native code.

1. The adaptation model — what is shared, what adapts

Concern	Shared (one design language)	Adapts per platform
Colour palette + connection-state meaning	yes — one token source [COLOR §3], light+dark	the export form that carries it (CSS / Dart / SwiftUI / Compose / ArkTS / C-Qt) [TEP §4]
Components (ConnectButton, StatusChip, ...)	yes — one catalog [CL §0]	native-shim surface uses native controls (SwiftUI/Compose/ArkUI/Qt)
Type ramp + bundled brand font	yes in the Flutter app [TIM §1]	native shims use the system font (D-TYPE-1)
Navigation structure	the responsive AdaptiveScaffold rule [UIF §2.1]	bottom-nav vs rail vs multi-pane resolved by width , plus per-OS back/affordance idioms
Light / dark	mandatory both ([TEP] DS-LIGHT-DARK-COMPLETE)	the per-OS auto / system-theme wiring mechanism (§11)
Motion + reduced-motion	one motion-token set [TIM §6]	honoured via each OS's reduce-motion signal (§11, §13)
Accessibility semantics	one Flutter Semantics tree [CL §1.3]	maps to the OS a11y API (VoiceOver / TalkBack / Narrator / Orca) (§16)

Concern	Shared (one design language)	Adapts per platform
Tunnel capability	the TunnelStatus-driven UI	absent on Web (NoCore) [WEB §3]; present on the other 7

Honest boundary (§11.4.6). "One design language" guarantees brand + meaning consistency; it does **not** mean pixel-identical rendering — each platform's compositor, text-shaper, density, and safe-area geometry differ, and the visual-regression suite captures a **per-platform, per-theme** golden, not one universal golden ([visual-regression-and-qa.md], §11.4.162/.168).

2. iOS

Design-language posture. Flutter app surface = the HelixVPN brand design language (Material-3-foundation, brand-font bundled). HelixVPN deliberately does **not** reskin to Cupertino controls (D-PA-1) — the ConnectButton / StatusChip are the shared catalog [CL §2, §3]. iOS HIG conventions that **are** honoured without changing the control set: the system back-swipe gesture, bottom safe-area respect, large-title-style screen headers via headline.lg [TIM §1.1], the home-indicator inset, and Dynamic-Type-equivalent scaling (the type ramp scales with the OS text-size setting where Flutter exposes it — UNVERIFIED exact Flutter↔Dynamic-Type binding, pinned per §11.4.99).

Token binding form. SwiftUI form [TEP §4.3] — HelixTokens.swift + .xcassets **asset-catalog colorsets** (one colorset per themed colour, light + dark appearance). This is the load-bearing iOS theme carrier: a colorset holds both appearances and is resolved by @Environment(\.colorScheme) **automatically** by the OS, so the **native-shim surface** (the NEPacketTunnelProvider config UI, SwiftUI [APPLE §1]) gets correct light/dark with zero runtime branching. The **Flutter app** consumes the Dart ThemeData form [TEP §4.2] (helixLight() / helixDark()), not the Swift form — the Swift export is for the SwiftUI shim surface only.

Navigation idiom. Compact width (phone) → bottom navigation + single pane [UIF §2.1]; the Client home is the ConnectButton hero [CL §2]. iPad (medium / expanded) → NavigationRail / multi-pane via the same width rule.

System theme (light/dark/auto). Flutter MaterialApp(themeMode: system) + the SwiftUI shim's asset-catalog auto-resolution; both follow the iOS Appearance setting and switch live on toggle. Light + dark are both first-class ([TEP] DS-LIGHT-DARK-COMPLETE).

Safe-areas / notches / insets. Notch / Dynamic Island / home-indicator respected via Flutter SafeArea + MediaQuery.viewPadding; the ConnectButton hero never renders under the status bar or the home indicator (the [CL §1.5] no-overlap guarantee extended to device cutouts). Keyboard insets via MediaQuery.viewInsets.

Density / input. Touch-first; $\geq 44 \times 44$ pt hit targets are already the [CL §1.3] floor (Apple HIG's own minimum). No mouse/remote on iPhone; iPad supports pointer (hover states from [CL §1.2] apply when a trackpad is attached).

Component substitution. None at the control level (D-PA-1) — the toggle is the shared ShieldToggle [CL §5], not UISwitch. The **only** native-control surface is the SwiftUI NE-config shim, which uses native SwiftUI Toggle/Label because it is native code [APPLE §2].

Native-shim surface. SwiftUI, system font (SF Pro / SF Mono) per D-TYPE-1 [TIM §2.2]; same palette via the asset-catalog colorsets [TEP §4.3]. Tiny surface (a toggle + a status line) — the iOS NE memory ceiling [APPLE §6] forbids bundling the brand font into the extension.

Accessibility API. Flutter Semantics → **VoiceOver**; the stateful ConnectButton name ("Connected, direct path, 28 milliseconds") is read on change via a polite live-region, Danger via an assertive announcement [CL §2 a11y]. Dynamic-Type-equivalent text scaling honoured.

3. macOS

Design-language posture. Same brand design language as iOS, **desktop-class**. HelixVPN does not adopt AppKit/SwiftUI native controls for the Flutter surface (D-PA-1); it honours macOS conventions that do not require a control swap: window chrome / traffic-light inset, menu-bar integration (a status-item / menu-bar VPN toggle is a natural macOS affordance — UNVERIFIED whether MVP ships a menu-bar extra; surfaced §18), keyboard-first navigation, and pointer hover states [CL §1.2].

Token binding form. SwiftUI form [TEP §4.3] for the native (System Extension) shim surface; Dart ThemeData for the Flutter app. macOS does **not** share the iOS NE memory ceiling [APPLE §6.5], so the desktop shim surface is not size-constrained.

Navigation idiom. Expanded width → extended NavigationRail + multi-pane [UIF §2.1] (macOS windows are large); resizing the window down reflows to rail/bottom-nav by the same width rule.

System theme. themeMode: system + the asset-catalog auto-resolution follow the macOS Appearance (Light / Dark / Auto) setting; the macOS "graphite/accent" tint is **not** adopted for the brand accent (the connection-state palette is brand-fixed [COLOR §3]).

Safe-areas / insets. No notch on most Macs (notebook camera-housing menubar inset handled by the OS); window title-bar inset respected. Keyboard insets are N/A (desktop).

Density / input. Pointer + keyboard first: focus rings always visible ([CL §1.2] focusRing), full keyboard navigation, a ⌘K command palette on the Console [WEB §5.1]/[UIF]. ≥44 px hit targets still apply (pointer precision does not relax the a11y floor, but sm/md densities [CL §1.6] are appropriate for dense desktop tables).

Component substitution. None at the control level. The native shim surface (if a separate System-Extension config window exists) is SwiftUI/AppKit-native.

Native-shim surface. SwiftUI, system font [TIM §2.2]; same palette [TEP §4.3]. Desktop-class memory.

Accessibility API. Flutter Semantics → **VoiceOver** (macOS); full keyboard navigation + focus order [CL §1.3]; macOS "Increase contrast" / "Reduce motion" accessibility settings honoured (reduce-motion degrades the connect pulse to a static ring [CL §2, TIM §8]).

4. Android

Design-language posture. Flutter renders **Material 3** natively here — the brand design language *is* a Material-3-foundation system [UIF §2.1], so Android is the most "native-feeling" of the eight without any reskin: ThemeData(useMaterial3: true) + the generated lightColorScheme() / darkColorScheme() [TEP §4.4]. The system **back button / gesture** and predictive-back are honoured by Flutter's navigator. Material's edge-to-edge + dynamic-color (Material You) is **not** adopted for the brand accent (the connection-state palette is brand-fixed [COLOR §3]); the M3 primary/surface/error slots carry the brand + error mapping while the connection-state colours are exposed as HelixColors tokens the StatusChip / ConnectButton read directly [TEP §4.4].

Token binding form. Jetpack **Compose** form [TEP §4.4] — HelixTokens.kt + M3 lightColorScheme/darkColorScheme — for the **native-shim surfaces** (the quick-settings **tile** and the VpnService foreground-service **notification** [ANDROID §7]). The Flutter app uses the Dart ThemeData form [TEP §4.2].

Navigation idiom. Compact → BottomNavigationBar; medium → NavigationRail; expanded (foldables / tablets / Chromebooks) → extended rail / multi-pane, all by width [UIF §2.1]. The foreground-service notification (an Android requirement to survive background-kill [ANDROID §7]) reflects TunnelStatus text ("Protected · masque-h3 · 23 ms") [ANDROID §8.3].

System theme. themeMode: system follows the Android Dark-theme setting; Compose shim surfaces follow isSystemInDarkTheme(); light + dark mandatory.

Safe-areas / insets. Display cutouts / gesture-nav inset / status + nav bars via Flutter SafeArea + MediaQuery; edge-to-edge handled so content never sits under the system bars (no-overlap [CL §1.5]). IME insets via viewInsets.

Density / input. Touch-first; foldable + Chromebook (mouse/ keyboard) supported via the width rule + hover states [CL §1.2]. **Android TV** is the platform where the **TV-leanback focus model** applies (§13): D-pad focus traversal, xl component size + a larger focus ring [CL §1.6]. UNVERIFIED whether Android TV is an MVP target vs Phase-2 — the leanback design is specified but the ship-gating is [SPINE §3]-dependent; marked here, not assumed.

Component substitution. None at the control level — the shared ShieldToggle [CL §5], not a raw Switch. The native quick-settings tile is a Compose-native Tile because it is OS-native code [ANDROID §7].

Native-shim surface. Compose, system font (Roboto) per D-TYPE-1 [TIM §2.2]; same palette via the generated M3 ColorScheme [TEP §4.4]. The quick-settings tile + the persistent notification.

Accessibility API. Flutter Semantics → **TalkBack**; the stateful ConnectButton name + live-region announcements [CL §2]; TV-leanback focus order is deterministic and D-pad-navigable (§13).

5. Windows

Design-language posture. Flutter app surface = the brand design language (Material-3-foundation), **not** WinUI/Fluent controls (D-PA-1). Windows conventions honoured without a control swap: window chrome / title-bar, keyboard-first + pointer hover, system tray affordance (a tray icon + connect toggle is a

natural Windows VPN idiom — UNVERIFIED whether MVP ships a tray integration; surfaced §18), and the Mica/acrylic backdrop is **not** adopted (the brand surface tokens are fixed [COLOR §2]).

Token binding form. The Flutter app uses the Dart ThemeData form [TEP §4.2]. **Windows has no Flutter-bundled native-shim UI surface in the design sense** — the privileged tunnel core runs in a **SYSTEM service** (HelixTunnelSvc, C#/Rust) the unprivileged Flutter app talks to over a **named pipe** (\\.\pipe\helixvpn); the Dart TunnelPlatform impl is WindowsPipeTunnelPlatform, not the default MethodChannel [UIF §4.4, WIN]. The service has **no UI** — there is no SwiftUI/Compose-class shim surface to theme; all user-facing UI is the Flutter app. (UNVERIFIED exact service↔app theme-handoff details — pinned against [WIN] before that surface ships.)

Navigation idiom. Expanded width (desktop windows are large) → extended NavigationRail / multi-pane [UIF §2.1]; reflows to rail/ bottom-nav on resize.

System theme. themeMode: system follows the Windows "Choose your mode" (Light / Dark) setting + the high-contrast themes; the Windows **accent colour** is **not** adopted for the brand accent (connection-state palette is brand-fixed [COLOR §3]). Light + dark mandatory; the CSS/Compose/Swift forms are not used on Windows — only Dart ThemeData.

Safe-areas / insets. No device notches; window-edge + title-bar insets only. Keyboard insets N/A (desktop).

Density / input. Pointer + keyboard first — focus rings, %/Ctrl-K palette (Console), full keyboard nav; sm/md densities for dense tables [CL §1.6].

Component substitution. None at the control level.

Native-shim surface. None in the themed sense (headless SYSTEM service); same palette is irrelevant to the service (no UI). All UI is brand-design-language Flutter.

Accessibility API. Flutter Semantics → **Narrator** (UI Automation); keyboard focus order + visible focus rings [CL §1.3]; Windows "Show animations" / high-contrast honoured (reduce-motion → static states [TIM §8]).

6. Linux

Design-language posture. Flutter app surface = the brand design language, **not** GTK/libadwaita or Qt native controls (D-PA-1). Linux desktops are diverse (GNOME / KDE / others);

HelixVPN renders the **same** brand system regardless of DE rather than chasing per-DE theming — which keeps the connection-state meaning identical and avoids a per-DE matrix the project cannot fully verify (UNVERIFIED per-DE theme-integration depth — beyond following the freedesktop dark-mode preference, see below).

Token binding form. Dart ThemeData [TEP §4.2] for the Flutter app. The Linux tunnel shim is a native helper (wireguard/tun via a privileged path [LINUX]) with **no themed UI surface** — all UI is the Flutter app.

Navigation idiom. Expanded → extended NavigationRail / multi-pane [UIF §2.1]; width-reflow.

System theme. themeMode: system follows the freedesktop / XDG dark-mode preference (org.freedesktop.appearance color-scheme) where the desktop exposes it and Flutter surfaces it (UNVERIFIED exact Flutter-Linux dark-preference binding across DEs — pinned per §11.4.99; the safe default is a manual light/dark toggle in HelixVPN settings so the user is never stuck on the wrong theme). Light + dark mandatory.

Safe-areas / insets. No device notches; window-edge insets only.

Density / input. Pointer + keyboard first — focus rings, palette, full keyboard nav, dense-table densities [CL §1.6].

Component substitution. None at the control level.

Native-shim surface. None in the themed sense (headless privileged tunnel helper [LINUX]); all UI is brand-design-language Flutter.

Accessibility API. Flutter Semantics → **Orca** (AT-SPI / ATK); keyboard focus order + visible focus rings [CL §1.3]; reduce-motion honoured where the DE exposes the preference (UNVERIFIED per-DE reduce-motion signal — manual setting fallback, never a silent ignore §11.4.6).

7. Web (Console)

Design-language posture. The Web flavor is the **Console only** — the admin app [WEB §0]; **Access and Connector do not build to Web** because a browser cannot open a system TUN ([WEB §1], §11.4.112 structural fact). It renders the **same** brand design language as the desktop Console build (one Flutter web app, CanvasKit default / -wasm for heavy tables [WEB §2.4]) — never Electron, never a webview-wrap [WEB §9]. The Console is admin-dense (tables, policy editor, topology) so it leans desktop conventions (pointer + keyboard, ⌘K/Ctrl-K palette).

Token binding form. CSS custom properties [TEP §4.1] — dist/css/helix.css with :root (light) + [data-theme="dark"] (dark) + a @media (prefers-color-scheme: dark) block so OS dark works without an explicit attribute. This is the **only** platform where the CSS export is the theme carrier (every other platform uses the Dart ThemeData form for the Flutter app). The Flutter web build also carries the Dart ThemeData form for its own widgets; the helix.css is for web chrome / @font-face self-hosting [TIM §2.2].

Navigation idiom. Width-responsive [WEB §5]: compact (<600) → bottom-nav + single pane; medium (600–1024) → NavigationRail + master/detail; expanded (>1024) → extended rail + multi-pane (list | detail | live events). Path-based clean URLs + route-level deferred loading of heavy admin modules [WEB §2.4]. WS/SSE-driven live data (push, never poll) with a "reconnecting... last updated HH:MM:SS" honesty banner [WEB §7.3].

System theme. prefers-color-scheme via the @media block in helix.css [TEP §4.1] + Flutter themeMode: system; an explicit data-theme attribute overrides for a manual toggle. Light + dark mandatory; admins skew dark [WEB §5.3].

Safe-areas / insets. Browser viewport — no device cutouts (mobile-web uses the browser's own chrome insets); responsive reflow handles small viewports.

Density / input. Pointer + keyboard first (the most desktop-like platform): focus rings, ⌘K/Ctrl-K command palette, full keyboard nav [WEB §5.1].

Component substitution. None — the same shared catalog. The **StatusChip** is reused **only** by the optional browser-scoped WASM-proxy chip (Phase 3), driven by a **distinct** ProxyStatus type (never TunnelStatus) with explicit "this tab only — not a device VPN" honesty copy [WEB §8.4/§8.5]. There is **no ConnectButton** on Web (no tunnel capability — tree-shaken [WEB §4]).

Capability gating. Capability.admin only — **no Capability.tunnel**, so helixCoreProvider resolves to NoCore and every tunnel widget (ConnectButton, ShieldToggle, ExitPicker) is tree-shaken out [WEB §4]; the CM-WEB-NO-CORE-FFI build gate asserts zero helix_core_ff dart:ffi in the web graph [WEB §2.3].

Native-shim surface. None (browser sandbox). The optional in-page **WASM MASQUE proxy** is page-scoped, not a system VPN [WEB §8].

Accessibility API. Flutter web emits **ARIA** roles (the [CL §1.3] roles map to DOM ARIA); state announced not colour-only [WEB §5.3]; the topology graph ships a treegrid non-visual fallback alongside the visual canvas [CL §9].

8. HarmonyOS

Design-language posture. Flutter app surface = the brand design language via the **OpenHarmony Flutter SIG fork** (flutter-ohos, pinned per fork [UIF §1.4]) — the same shared catalog [CL]. HelixVPN does **not** reskin to HarmonyDesign / ArkUI native components for the Flutter surface (D-PA-1). HarmonyDesign / ArkUI conventions are honoured **only** on the **native-shim surface** (the VpnExtensionAbility, ArkTS/ArkUI [UIF §4.4, OHOS]) — its toggle + status line use native ArkUI components because that surface is genuinely ArkTS code. UNVERIFIED: the precise HarmonyDesign navigation / component conventions the ArkUI shim should follow are HarmonyOS-SDK-version-dependent and are pinned + re-verified per §11.4.99 against the live HarmonyOS docs before the ArkTS surface ships — **not** asserted here (§11.4.6).

Token binding form. ArkTS form [TEP §4.5] — helix_tokens.ets + the HarmonyOS resource qualifier tree (resources/base/element/color.json = light, resources/dark/element/color.json = dark; the OS resolves the qualifier by system theme). UNVERIFIED (U-EXP-1 [TEP §4.5]): the exact `$r('app.color....')` resolver key form + the resources/dark/ qualifier directory name are SDK-version-dependent — pinned per §11.4.99 before the ArkTS exporter ships. The **Flutter app** uses the Dart ThemeData form [TEP §4.2] (the Flutter SIG fork renders Dart themes); the ArkTS form is for the ArkUI shim surface only.

Navigation idiom. Width-responsive AdaptiveScaffold on the Flutter surface [UIF §2.1]; the native ArkUI shim follows HarmonyDesign navigation (UNVERIFIED specifics, §11.4.99).

System theme. The ArkTS resources/{base,dark} qualifier tree resolves light/dark by the HarmonyOS system theme automatically [TEP §4.5]; the Flutter app uses themeMode: system. Light + dark mandatory. UNVERIFIED: the exact HarmonyOS dark-theme system signal Flutter surfaces — pinned per §11.4.99.

Safe-areas / insets. HarmonyOS device cutouts / system bars handled via Flutter SafeArea + MediaQuery on the Flutter surface (UNVERIFIED SIG-fork inset parity with mainline — pinned per §11.4.99); the ArkUI shim uses native ArkUI safe-area APIs.

Density / input. Touch-first (phones / tablets); the brand font is bundled in the Flutter app, the ArkUI shim uses the system font (HarmonyOS Sans) per D-TYPE-1 [TIM §2.2].

Component substitution. None on the Flutter surface; the native ArkUI shim uses native ArkUI controls (it is ArkTS code) [OHOS].

Native-shim surface. ArkTS / ArkUI VpnExtensionAbility, system font [TIM §2.2]; same palette via the resources/{base,dark} qualifier export [TEP §4.5].

Accessibility API. Flutter Semantics → the HarmonyOS accessibility tree (UNVERIFIED exact HarmonyOS screen-reader / a11y service name + the SIG-fork Semantics mapping — pinned per §11.4.99; the [CL §1.3] semantic roles are emitted regardless, never colour-only).

9. Aurora

Design-language posture. Flutter app surface = the brand design language via the **OMP flutter-aurora fork** (pinned per fork [UIF §1.4]) — the same shared catalog [CL]. HelixVPN does **not** reskin to Sailfish **Silica** (the Aurora/ Sailfish Qt component set) for the Flutter surface (D-PA-1). Silica-Qt conventions are honoured **only** on the **native-shim surface** (the Qt/C++ tunnel backend's config UI, if present [UIF §4.4, AURORA]) because that is genuinely Qt code. UNVERIFIED: the precise Silica navigation / gesture conventions (Sailfish's pulley-menu / cover idioms) the Qt shim should follow are Aurora-SDK-version-dependent and are pinned + re-verified per §11.4.99 before that surface ships — **not** asserted here (§11.4.6). Aurora is the **ru-market** platform (ru is a first-tier locale [UIF §2.5]), so localized connection-state legibility matters most here.

Token binding form. C / Qt form [TEP §4.6] — helix_tokens.h (#define constants) + Theme.qml (a QML singleton exposing a light/dark property set, switched by a dark property) — for the Qt/C++ shim surface. UNVERIFIED (U-EXP-2 [TEP §4.6]): the exact QML singleton registration (qmlDir / .qrc / module-import form) is Aurora-Qt-version-dependent — pinned per §11.4.99 before the C/Qt exporter ships. The **Flutter app** uses the Dart ThemeData form [TEP §4.2] (the Aurora Flutter fork renders Dart themes); the C/Qt form is for the Qt shim surface only.

Navigation idiom. Width-responsive AdaptiveScaffold on the Flutter surface [UIF §2.1]; the native Qt/Silica shim follows Sailfish navigation (UNVERIFIED pulley-menu / cover specifics, §11.4.99).

System theme. The QML Theme.qml singleton's dark property switches the Qt-shim light/dark set [TEP §4.6]; the Flutter app uses themeMode: system. Sailfish's **ambience** system (user-chosen accent + light/dark) is **not** adopted for the brand accent (the connection-state palette is brand-fixed [COLOR §3]); UNVERIFIED

whether the Aurora ambience light/dark signal drives Theme.qml.dark automatically vs a manual toggle — pinned per §11.4.99. Light + dark mandatory.

Safe-areas / insets. Aurora device geometry handled via the Flutter fork's SafeArea/MediaQuery (UNVERIFIED fork inset parity — pinned per §11.4.99) on the Flutter surface; the Qt shim uses native Qt safe-area handling.

Density / input. Touch-first; brand font bundled in the Flutter app, the Qt shim uses the system font per D-TYPE-1 [TIM §2.2].

Component substitution. None on the Flutter surface; the native Qt shim uses native Silica-Qt controls [AURORA].

Native-shim surface. Qt / C++ (Silica), system font [TIM §2.2]; same palette via the helix_tokens.h + Theme.qml export [TEP §4.6].

Accessibility API. Flutter Semantics → the Aurora/Qt accessibility tree (UNVERIFIED exact Aurora screen-reader + the Qt-shim QAccessible mapping — pinned per §11.4.99; the [CL §1.3] semantic roles are emitted regardless, never colour-only). Localized state strings (ru) are first-class [UIF §2.5].

10. The platform × adaptation matrix

Platform	Flutter-app design language	Token-export form (shim surface)	Nav idiom (by width)	System-theme mechanism
iOS	brand (M3-foundation), bundled font	SwiftUI .xcassets colorsets [TEP §4.3]	bottom-nav / rail (iPad)	colorScheme auto + themeMode:system
macOS	brand, desktop-class	SwiftUI colorsets [TEP §4.3]	extended rail / multi-pane	colorScheme auto + themeMode:system
Android	brand = M3 native [UIF §2.1]	Compose M3 ColorScheme [TEP §4.4] Dart ThemeData	bottom-nav → rail → multi-pane	isSystemInDarkTheme() + themeMode:system
Windows	brand	(no themed	extended rail / multi-pane	themeMode:system (Win mode)

Platform	Flutter-app design language	Token-export form (shim surface)	Nav idiom (by width)	System-theme mechanism
Linux	brand (DE-agnostic)	shim) [TEP §4.2] Dart ThemeData (no themed shim) [TEP §4.2]	extended rail / multi-pane	XDG color-scheme + themeMode:system UNVERIFIED
Web	brand (Console only)	CSS :root/[data-theme]/@media [TEP §4.1]	bottom-nav → rail → multi-pane	prefers-color-scheme + data-theme
HarmonyOS	brand (SIG fork)	ArkTS resources/{base,dark} [TEP §4.5] UNVERIFIED	AdaptiveScaffold by width	resource qualifier auto UNVERIFIED
Aurora	brand (OMP fork)	C/Qt .h + Theme.qml [TEP §4.6] UNVERIFIED	AdaptiveScaffold by width	QML Theme.qml.dark UNVERIFIED

Every row ships **light + dark** ([TEP] DS-LIGHT-DARK-COMPLETE) and a per-platform / per-theme golden in the visual-regression suite (§11.4.162/.168, [visual-regression-and-qa.md]). Web is the only row with **no tunnel capability** (NoCore [WEB §4]).

11. System theme (light / dark / auto) integration per OS

Light **and** dark are mandatory on every platform — a target emitting one theme fails the [TEP] DS-LIGHT-DARK-COMPLETE gate. The **mechanism** that picks the OS theme differs per platform; the **values** are the same token source [DT §5.1], theme-split into a light table + a dark table at export [TEP §3.2].

Platform	Auto/system-theme signal	Carrier form	Manual override
iOS / macOS	OS Appearance → @Environment(\.colorScheme)	asset-catalog colorset	in-app light/dark toggle

Platform	Auto/system-theme signal	Carrier form	Manual override
	(shim) + themeMode:system (Flutter)	(both appearances) [TEP §4.3]	(Flutter themeMode)
Android / HarmonyOS	Dark-theme setting → isSystemInDarkTheme() / resource qualifier + themeMode:system	Compose ColorScheme [TEP §4.4] / ArkTS resources/dark [TEP §4.5]	in-app toggle
Windows	"Choose your mode" + high-contrast → themeMode:system	Dart ThemeData [TEP §4.2]	in-app toggle
Linux	XDG org.freedesktop.appearance color-scheme UNVERIFIED → themeMode:system	Dart ThemeData [TEP §4.2]	in-app toggle (the safe default when the DE signal is unavailable)
Web	prefers-color-scheme (@media) + data-theme attribute	CSS custom properties [TEP §4.1]	data-theme="light dark" toggle
Aurora	ambience light/dark UNVERIFIED → Theme.qml.dark	C/Qt Theme.qml singleton [TEP §4.6]	in-app toggle

Honesty (§11.4.6). Where the OS auto-theme signal is UNVERIFIED (Linux XDG, HarmonyOS qualifier, Aurora ambience), the **safe default is a manual in-app light/dark toggle** so the user is never stranded on the wrong theme — the auto binding is added once verified per §11.4.99, never guessed.

System dark-mode interplay with the connection-state palette: on **dark** the ConnectButton ring glow renders brighter (the .500 state stops) and the connected glow has higher alpha so the halo reads on #151920 [CL §2]; the white on-state label stays white in both themes (proven AA on the coloured fill, [COLOR §4.3]). Reduce-motion (an OS accessibility setting on every platform) degrades the Connecting/Reconnecting pulse to a static ring via motion.semantic.reducedMotion [TIM §8, CL §1.3].

12. Navigation idioms & responsive breakpoints

The navigation structure is resolved by **width, not Platform.isX** — the single AdaptiveScaffold rule [UIF §2.1, WEB §5] — so the same build behaves correctly on a phone, a resized desktop window, a foldable, and the web:

compact (< 600 px) → BottomNavigationBar · single pane
medium (600–1024 px) → NavigationRail · master/detail
expanded (> 1024 px) → extended NavigationRail · multi-pane (list | detail | live)

Per-platform navigation idioms layered on top of the width rule:

Platform	Layered idiom
iOS	system back-swipe; large-title-style headers (headline.lg); bottom-nav on phone
macOS / Windows / Linux	window chrome; menu/tray affordance UNVERIFIED (§18); ⌘K/Ctrl-K palette (Console); extended rail
Android	system back / predictive-back; foreground-service notification mirrors status [ANDROID §8.3]; foldable multi-pane
Web	path-based clean URLs; route-level deferred loading; WS/SSE live panes with staleness banner [WEB §5/§7.3]
HarmonyOS	HarmonyDesign navigation on the ArkUI shim UNVERIFIED (§11.4.99)
Aurora	Sailfish pulley-menu / cover idioms on the Qt shim UNVERIFIED (§11.4.99)

The Client home is always the ConnectButton hero [CL §2]; the Console is the admin shell (Tenants · Devices · Networks · Policy · Audit · Topology) [WEB §5.1]; the Connector is the appliance dashboard (the headless Connector entrypoint has no UI at all [UIF §5.4]).

13. Input model, density & the TV-leanback focus model

Input model	Platforms	Design consequence
Touch	iOS (iPhone), Android (phone/tablet),	

Input model	Platforms	Design consequence
Pointer + keyboard	HarmonyOS, Aurora, iPad (no pointer)	≥44×44 px hit targets (the [CL §1.3] floor); md/lg densities [CL §1.6]
	macOS, Windows, Linux, Web; iPad w/ trackpad; Chromebook	always-visible focus rings [CL §1.2]; *K palette; sm/md dense tables; hover states
Remote (D-pad)	TV-leanback (Android TV UNVERIFIED MVP-gating)	xl component size + a larger focus ring [CL §1.6]; deterministic D-pad focus order

The TV-leanback focus model. Where HelixVPN runs on a 10-foot TV surface (the leanback context [SPINE §3]), the design adapts: components use the xl size (56 px min height [CL §1.6]), the focus ring is enlarged so it reads across the room, and focus traversal is **D-pad-driven** with a deterministic, predictable order (no mouse, no touch) — the [CL §1.2] focus model with a TV-scaled ring. This is the one place the **size token** (xl) and the focus affordance change by platform context rather than by width. UNVERIFIED: which of the eight platforms actually ships a TV-leanback surface in MVP (Android TV is the natural candidate) vs Phase-2 — the leanback design is specified but the ship-gating is [SPINE §3]-dependent; marked, not assumed (§11.4.6).

Density never relaxes the a11y floor: a visually-sm 32 px control still keeps a 44 px transparent tap area centred on its glyph [CL §1.6]; pointer precision on desktop allows denser tables but the focus ring + keyboard path remain.

14. Safe-areas, notches & insets

Handled uniformly on the **Flutter surface** via SafeArea + MediaQuery (viewPadding for cutouts/bars, viewInsets for the keyboard) so the [CL §1.5] no-overlap / no-label-overlay guarantee extends to device geometry — the ConnectButton hero never renders under a status bar, notch, home indicator, or IME.

Platform	Insets handled
iOS	notch / Dynamic Island / home-indicator / status bar / keyboard
Android	display cutouts / gesture-nav bar / status + nav bars / IME (edge-to-edge)
HarmonyOS	device cutouts / system bars / IME (UNVERIFIED SIG-fork parity — §11.4.99)

Platform	Insets handled
Aurora	device geometry / system bars (UNVERIFIED fork parity — §11.4.99)
macOS / Windows / Linux	window-edge + title-bar insets; no device cutouts; keyboard N/A
Web	browser viewport; mobile-web browser-chrome insets; responsive reflow

The native-shim surfaces (SwiftUI / Compose / ArkUI / Qt) use their **own** native safe-area APIs because they are native code — the Flutter SafeArea applies only to the Flutter surface.

15. Capability gating per platform

Capability gating ([UIF §5.3]) decides which features compile into a flavor; it is also the mechanism that lets **Web omit the tunnel core** entirely.

Capability	iOS	macOS	Android	Windows	Linux	Web	
tunnel (ConnectButton, ShieldToggle, ExitPicker, core_ffl)	●	●	●	●	●	— (NoCore)	●
account (Access)	●	●	●	●	●	—	●
admin (Console screens)	(Console build)	●	(Console build)	●	●	●	(h

The **Web** column is the load-bearing exception: Capability.tunnel is **absent**, so helixCoreProvider = NoCore, every tunnel widget is tree-shaken, and the CM-WEB-NO-CORE-FFI gate asserts no dart:ffi reaches the web bundle [WEB §2.3/§4]. On the other seven platforms the tunnel capability is present and the ConnectButton is the hero. Console builds to desktop on macOS/Windows/Linux too (admin from a workstation), and to Web; Access/Connector build to the seven native platforms but **not** Web [WEB §0].

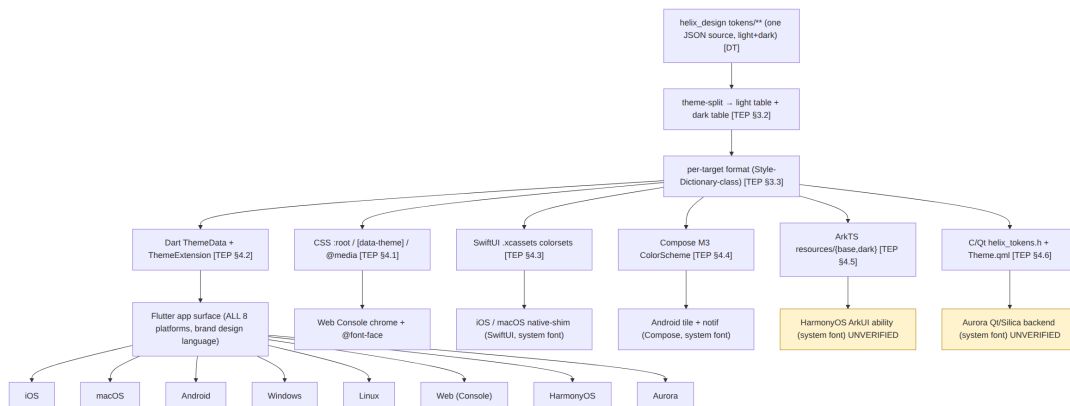
16. Accessibility APIs per platform

One Flutter Semantics tree [CL §1.3] (roles, names, focus order, live-regions) maps to each OS's accessibility API. The semantic content is identical across platforms — only the OS-side service differs:

Platform	A11y service	Notes
iOS / macOS	VoiceOver	stateful ConnectButton name read on change (polite); Danger assertive [CL §2]
Android	TalkBack	same live-region pattern; TV-leanback D-pad focus order (§13)
Windows	Narrator (UI Automation)	keyboard focus order + visible rings [CL §1.3]
Linux	Orca (AT-SPI / ATK)	keyboard nav; reduce-motion via DE preference UNVERIFIED
Web	ARIA (DOM roles)	the [CL §1.3] roles → ARIA; topology graph treegrid fallback [CL §9]
HarmonyOS	HarmonyOS a11y tree UNVERIFIED	SIG-fork Semantics mapping pinned per §11.4.99
Aurora	Qt/Aurora a11y (QAccessible) UNVERIFIED	localized (ru) state strings first-class [UIF §2.5]

Cross-cutting a11y guarantees that hold on **every** platform [CL §1.3]: explicit roles + non-empty accessible names; ≥ 44 px hit targets; AA-normal 4.5 / AA-large 3.0 / non-text 3.0 contrast proven in both themes [COLOR §4]; reduce-motion → static end-state [TIM §8]; **colour-independence** — every coloured state also carries a glyph + text, so the Connected vs Not protected distinction survives for a colour-blind user without the green/red [COLOR §0, CL §1.3]. This is itself a §11.4.162 mandate (no element overlaps a label) verified per platform/theme by the visual-regression golden.

17. The token → theme → platform binding



The **Flutter app surface** on every platform binds the **Dart ThemeData** form [TEP §4.2] — one consistent brand design language. The **other five forms** bind the **native-shim surface** of their platform (SwiftUI colorsets on Apple, Compose on Android, ArkTS on HarmonyOS, C/Qt on Aurora) and the **CSS** form binds web chrome. All six forms are generated from the **same** JSON source, so the palette is byte-faithful across every platform (the [TEP §5] drift gate proves no platform theme diverges from source).

18. Surfaced decisions & cross-doc contracts

id	Decision / contract	Status
D-PA-1	One brand design language adapted at the seams, not a per-OS native control reskin. Flutter app = the shared catalog on all 8 platforms (brand-consistency: the connect label must not differ in shape per OS [TIM §2.1]); native-shim surfaces follow each OS's own HIG/Material/HarmonyDesign/Silica because they are native code. Option B (full per-OS native control set) rejected for brand consistency.	decided
D-PA-2	Token-export form per surface — Flutter app = Dart ThemeData; iOS/macOS shim = SwiftUI colorsets; Android shim = Compose M3; HarmonyOS shim = ArkTS resources;	decided (per §17)

id	Decision / contract	Status
	Aurora shim = C/Qt; Web chrome = CSS [TEP §4].	
D-PA-3	Theme is system-driven by default with a manual in-app override on every platform; where the OS auto-signal is UNVERIFIED (Linux XDG / HarmonyOS qualifier / Aurora ambience), the manual toggle is the safe default until the auto binding is verified per §11.4.99.	decided (§11)
D-PA-4 UNVERIFIED	TV-leanback surface — xl size + enlarged D-pad focus ring [CL §1.6]; which platform ships it in MVP (Android TV candidate) vs Phase-2 is [SPINE §3]-dependent — pinned, not assumed.	open
D-PA-5 UNVERIFIED	Desktop menu-bar / system-tray affordance (macOS menu-bar extra, Windows tray, Linux indicator) — a natural VPN idiom; whether MVP ships it is surfaced, not silently decided (§11.4.66).	open
C-PA-A (consumes)	The seven export forms + the light/dark theme-split + the drift gate [TEP §3-§5] — this doc maps each form to its platform surface; a new form is a new platform binding here.	contract
C-PA-B (consumes)	The width-not-Platform.isX AdaptiveScaffold rule + the flavor/capability model [UIF §2.1, §5] — navigation + capability gating are resolved by width/capability, not OS identity.	contract
C-PA-C (consumes)	D-TYPE-1 (native shims use the system font , the Flutter app the bundled brand font) [TIM §2.2] — this doc applies it per platform.	contract
C-PA-D (consumes)	The no-system-tunnel-in-a-browser structural fact + the Console-only Web build + NoCore [WEB §1/§4] — the Web row's capability gating.	contract
U-PA-1 UNVERIFIED	HarmonyOS HarmonyDesign / ArkUI navigation + a11y + dark-signal specifics — pinned + re-verified per §11.4.99 before the ArkTS surface ships (composes [TEP] U-EXP-1).	open
		open

id	Decision / contract	Status
U-PA-2 UNVERIFIED	Aurora Sailfish-Silica navigation (pulley/cover) + ambience dark-signal + a11y specifics — pinned per §11.4.99 before the C/Qt surface ships (composes [TEP] U-EXP-2/U-EXP-3).	
U-PA-3 UNVERIFIED	Linux per-DE dark-preference + reduce-motion signal depth (GNOME/KDE/...) — manual toggle fallback until verified per §11.4.99.	open

Sources verified

- **The platform-adaptation posture (one brand design language adapted at the seams; the per-platform navigation / system-theme / safe-area / input / a11y mapping; the platform × adaptation matrix; the token→theme→platform binding) — NO external source needed — original HelixVPN design work**, layered on each framework's documented conventions (Flutter AdaptiveScaffold / Semantics / SafeArea / themeMode; SwiftUI asset-catalog colorsets; Compose Material 3 ColorScheme; HarmonyOS resource qualifiers; Qt QML; CSS prefers-color-scheme; the platform a11y services VoiceOver / TalkBack / Narrator / Orca / ARIA). The per-platform idioms are each framework's documented conventions; the *adaptation model* (what is shared vs what adapts, and D-PA-1) is HelixVPN's own design.
- **The seven token-export forms + the light/dark theme-split + the drift gate + every per-target output sample, and the UNVERIFIED markers U-EXP-1 (ArkTS resolver), U-EXP-2 (QML registration), U-EXP-3 (OpenDesign dark convention)** — final/v10-design/token-export-pipeline.md §3/§4/§5/§9 (sibling, this wave, read 2026-06-25). Each platform's binding form (§17, the matrix §10) is reproduced from that document.
- **The component catalog (ConnectButton/StatusChip states, the a11y baseline, the no-overlap / no-label-overlay guarantee, the sm/md/lg/xl size set + TV-leanback x1, the universal interaction/focus model)** — final/v10-design/component-library.md §0/§1.2/§1.3/§1.5/§1.6/§2/§3/§9 (sibling, read 2026-06-25).
- **The type ramp + the per-platform font strategy (D-TYPE-1 native-shim system font; bundled Inter/JetBrains Mono in the Flutter app; the system-font fallback chain) + reduced-motion** — final/v10-design/typography-iconography-motion.md §1/§2.1/§2.2/§8 (sibling, read 2026-06-25).

- **The token model (tiers, theming axes, light+dark fork) + the colour roles / connection-state palette / contrast proofs** — final/v10-design/design-tokens.md §1/§5 + final/v10-design/color-system.md §0/§2/§3/§4 (siblings, read 2026-06-25; load-bearing hexes reproduced via the export-pipeline samples).
- **The Flutter app shell (the width-not-Platform.isX AdaptiveSc afford rule, the flavor/capability model, runHelixApp, the per-platform native-shim signatures incl. Windows named-pipe WindowsPipeTunnelPlatform and Web NoTunnelPlatform, the OHOS/Aurora SIG-fork pins, the first-tier locales en/ru/zh-Hans)** — final/v04-client/helix-ui-flutter.md §1.4/§2.1/§2.5/§4.4/§5 (sibling, read 2026-06-25).
- **The per-platform tunnel-shim surfaces (iOS/macOS SwiftUI NE config + the iOS NE memory ceiling vs desktop-class macOS; Android Compose tile + foreground-service notification + TV/foldable input; HarmonyOS ArkTS VpnExtensionAbility; Aurora Qt/C++ backend; Windows SYSTEM-service named pipe)** — final/v04-client/shim-apple.md §1/§6/§6.5, final/v04-client/shim-android.md §7/§8.3 (read 2026-06-25); shim-windows.md, shim-linux.md, shim-harmonyos.md, shim-aurora.md referenced by filename for the per-OS native surface (their UI-surface specifics that are SDK-version-dependent are marked UNVERIFIED here, not asserted).
- **The Web Console (Console-only Web build, no system TUN structural fact, NoCore, CanvasKit/Wasm renderer, width breakpoints, OS-dark via prefers-color-scheme, ARIA a11y, the browser-scoped WASM proxy chip with distinct ProxyStatus)** — final/v04-client/web-console.md §0/§1/§2.4/§4/§5/§7.3/§8 (sibling, read 2026-06-25).
- **Constitution clauses** §11.4.6 (no-guessing — every UNVERIFIED marked, none fabricated), §11.4.66 (decisions surfaced as options, never silently resolved), §11.4.99 (latest-source cross-reference — the HarmonyOS/Aurora/Linux platform specifics are pinned + re-verified before the surface ships), §11.4.112 (structural impossibility — browser has no system TUN), §11.4.162 (OpenDesign UI design-system mandate, light+dark every component, no-overlap, visual-regression), §11.4.168 (exported-doc visual validation) — constitution submodule text embedded in this repo's constitution/CLAUDE.md, accessed 2026-06-25.
- Items explicitly marked UNVERIFIED (HarmonyOS HarmonyDesign/ArkUI navigation + a11y + dark-signal U-PA-1; Aurora Silica navigation + ambience + a11y U-PA-2; Linux per-DE dark + reduce-motion U-PA-3; TV-leanback MVP-gating D-PA-4; desktop menu/tray affordance D-PA-5) are pending their §11.4.99 verification pass — not asserted as fact (§11.4.6).